



WANTED: CYBER SECURITY EXPERTS

As more and more businesses go online, the burden to safeguard important data and secure the perimeter of their activities falls on the shoulders of cyber security professionals. And the world can't have enough of them at the moment!



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In December 2014, Sony Pictures tried to release a controversial movie that didn't go down well with North Korea, since it showed the assassination of their Supreme Leader. A standoff ensued, a media storm erupted, and Sony's systems were hacked at multiple levels. Not only did private communications between Sony Pictures' executive team be leaked (along with business documents and other personally identifiable information of employees), to further embarrass the company and add insult to injury information (and material) related to yet-to-be-announced-or-released movies was also leaked out into the open. This is just one example,

as most victims don't even know they've been breached, and most businesses don't report their hacks (to protect shareholders' interest and their brand equity).

Welcome to the world of eroding borders, corroding weapons; full of digital tools ready to be deployed at the click of a button, to wreck cyber mayhem not just on corporates or governments but every entity connected to the Internet. It's a war out there! There are just too many leaks and breaches, and not enough plumbers to fix the holes.

Security may not directly contribute to business' profit margin, but protecting critical data and digital assets are equally important, and more businesses are waking up to this reality.

Technology can only help up to a point, as ultimately, skilled profes-

sionals make all the difference in protecting data in a network environment. In the digital era, cyber security experts are in demand more than ever. And there's no end in sight to this boom.

Technical know-how

You can't hope to make it as a cyber security expert if you don't have the functional knowledge of how computers, and for that matter, digital systems and network infrastructure, operate. Naturally, anyone who's studying Computer Science is an obvious candidate for a prospective future role as a cyber security professional. Apart from that, there're a whole host of industry-accredited professional certifications that need to be obtained to further your growth prospect within the cyber security industry. A breakup of these specific qualifications and desirable skill sets is mentioned in the table alongside.

According to Dubai-based cyber security expert, Dr. Lalit Gupta, distinguished with over 20 years of experience in the domain of cyber security and information security for a global clientele, it's all about understanding the 1s and 0s of how a network infrastructure functions and operates. "Basically CS Professionals need to know fundamentals of how a network works," he says, "with strong fundamentals of hacking techniques and security processes." If you can't think like a hacker trying to gain access into an unauthorized network, you can't possibly imagine to stay one step ahead of the bad guys.

To understand the psyche of unwanted network intruders, he also stresses upon the requisite soft skills that go along with professional certifications which are